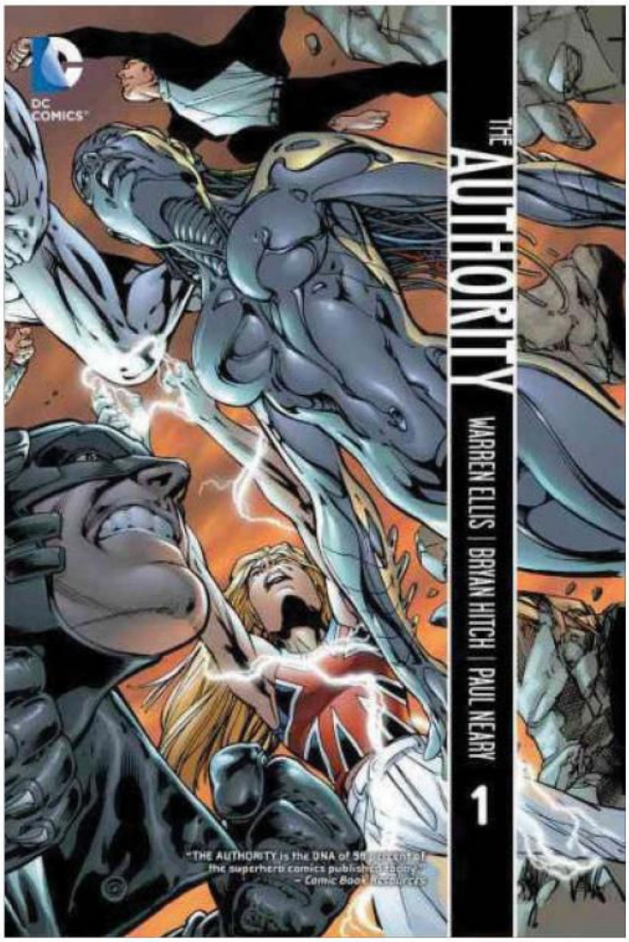


THE AUTHORITY

Details **Originally published** The Authority #1-12 (1999) **Publisher** Wildstorm **Writer** Warren Ellis **Artists** Bryan Hitch, Paul Neary, Laura Depuy **Collected in** The Authority: Vol 1 **Available digitally** Comixology, Kindle

Springing from the ruins of Warren Ellis' *Stormwatch* run (also essential, by the way), this run effortlessly balanced colossal ideas and spectacle with moments of real character. The grin of total, abject joy on the Engineer's face when she walks on the Moon is still a great moment, and the entire series is crammed full of moments like that.



Every single book that followed this run, including a good chunk of future *Authority* runs, failed miserably. That's because they forgot those character moments. Without them this is empty, even cruel spectacle. With them, this is three stories about hope and what happens when people are braver than they think they can be. The scale is huge; cities fall, thousands die, and we see it all in loving detail thanks to Bryan Hitch, Paul Neary and Laura Depuy. But it's the character moments that make the book shine and give it it's spot on this list.

INVINCIBLE: PERFECT STRANGERS

Details **Originally published** Invincible #9-13 (2004) **Publisher** Icon **Writer** Robert Kirkman **Artist** Cory Walker and Bill Crabtree **Collected in** Invincible Volume 3: Perfect Strangers **Available digitally** Kindle, Comixology

Proving that there's more to Robert Kirkman than the unrelenting misery of *The Walking Dead*, *Invincible* – with the bold art of Cory Walker and Bill Crabtree – was effectively the best *Spider-Man* comic that Joss Whedon never wrote, following teen titan Mark Grayson as he learned to balance the legacy of his Superman-like father Omni-Man with the usual school/bullies/dating worries of the trainee hero.



Smart, fast-paced and bouncier than a puppy in a tumble dryer, the series' third arc capped of the origin story with a devastating escalation, tearing the status quo limb from limb and subjecting this post-modern mash-up of Silver Age tropes to the sort of shock and awe that has made Kirkman's zombie apocalypse such a hit.

Perfect Strangers (each arc is named after a sitcom, which gives you a good idea of what you're dealing with) marked the point where *Invincible* went from being the comic equivalent of a Saturday morning cartoon to full-blown box-set obsession.

